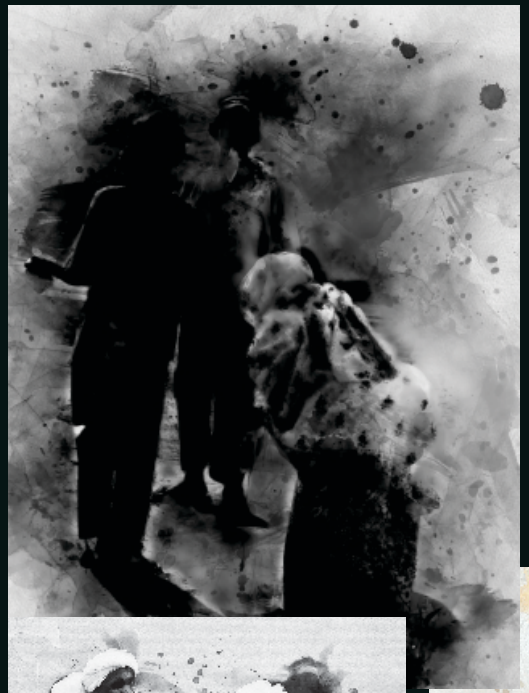
Ozuwo Enifome

THE ART OF EVERYDAY LIFE

Fine Art & Documentary Photography









Ozuwo Enifome

Ozuwo Enifome is a Nigerian artist whose photographs begin with people going about their lives. He is drawn to unremarkable but revealing moments: friends resting together, a woman attending to her work, figures at the water's edge, someone standing alone where the light changes.

The works in this catalogue offer a personal, attentive view of everyday life. They are photographs shaped by an artist who observes closely, and who recognises that a fleeting gesture can stay with us long after the moment has passed.
His photographs are made from his own original images and then reinterpreted through digital artistic treatment. Some retain the directness of black-and-white photography; others use selective colour or wash-like textures that recall drawing and painting. These effects do not turn the photographs into physical paintings. They change the emotional distance between the viewer and what was seen.

Enifome is interested in the quiet complexity of ordinary experience.
His subjects are never simply illustrations of an idea. A bowed head can hold several possible meanings; people sitting close together can still feel far apart. His practice is most compelling when it allows such contradictions to remain visible.

The lives within the frame

There is a kind of encounter that lasts only a few seconds but refuses to disappear from memory. Someone bends beneath the weight of a thought. Two friends sit without speaking. A figure stands in a doorway, separated from the world by a thin rectangle of light. Ozuwo Enifome returns to such moments and asks us to look at them longer.

The Art of Everyday Life brings together twelve works dated between 2016 and 2020. They share an interest in how people inhabit public spaces, work alongside one another and make room for private feelings within a crowded world. Yet these are not straightforward documentary records. Enifome treats the original photographs, at times dissolving surroundings into charcoal-like tones, at others allowing a flash of yellow or red to carry the image.
It would be easy to assign every sitter a biography or to turn each picture into a lesson. The photographs are stronger for refusing that. Their feeling comes from what can genuinely be observed: the distance between bodies, a shared pause, an uncertain gesture, the fall of light. Enifome's achievement is to make these modest details carry lasting emotional weight.

What emerges is not a single account of Nigerian life, but a series of humane encounters. In their different ways, they speak about labour, belonging, solitude, companionship, movement and hope. Above all, they remind us that the ordinary is never without consequence.

The treatments are most effective when they clarify what matters. In Friends, the surroundings fall quiet so that companionship can take centre stage. In The Contrast of Life I, colour shines while the subject's inward posture complicates the brightness. Light at the End of the Tunnel leaves us with a human silhouette and a possibility we cannot yet see. Each work asks us to bring our own lived experience to the image.

About this edition

THE SELECTION

This publication contains the twelve photographic works illustrated in the most recently supplied sixteen-page source catalogue. The source cover states eighteen artworks, but only twelve individual photographs are illustrated. No outside works have been added.

ORDER AND TITLES

The works are presented chronologically by the years printed in that document: 2016, 2018 and 2020. Within a year, the order follows the source sequence. Titles are normalised for spelling and capitalisation without changing their underlying meaning.

ORIGINAL PHOTOGRAPHY

Each work is based on an original photograph made and artistically treated by Ozuwo Enifome. Painterly-looking textures visible in a reproduction should not be mistaken for physical acrylic or watercolour applied to the final print.

DATES AND DIMENSIONS

The year and size beside each work follow the source records. The measurement for Market Woman is reproduced as an unverified source entry. Capture date, date of treatment, final print dimensions and print date should be distinguished in the signed object record.

UNIQUE 1/1 PRINTS

The artist intends to issue one physical saleable print per work, a unique 1/1 edition. The catalogue describes the edition commitment; individual prints, material specifications and signed certificates must be documented at production.

The photographs

OE-PH001 The Hopelessness of Hope 2016

OE-PH002 Three Is Company 2016

OE-PH003 Untitled 2016

OE-PH004 Friends 2016

OE-PH005 The Contrast of Life I 2018

OE-PH006 Market Woman 2018

OE-PH007 The Contrast of Life II 2018

OE-PH008 Fulani Woman 2018

OE-PH009 Light at the End of the Tunnel 2018

OE-PH010 Face to Face Conversation 2020

OE-PH011 Kids Washing by the Banks 2020

OE-PH012 The Argungu Sprint 2020

OE-PH001

The hopelessness of hope

2016 | 30 × 22 in

Original photography; artistically interpreted digital image

Two figures come forward through a haze of greys. One remains upright; the other seems to fold into the weight of what is being carried. Their outlines are partly swallowed by the surrounding marks, making it difficult to separate the people from the hardship that the picture suggests. The emotional force of this work lies in that uncertainty.

Enifome does not turn suffering into spectacle or offer the viewer an easy resolution. Instead, the almost erased faces and heavy tonal passages ask us to consider what it means to see someone in distress and still know so little about their life. The title carries a painful contradiction: hope survives here, but it is being tested.



OE-PH002

Three is Company

2016 | 16 × 22 in

Original photography; artistically interpreted digital image

Three men sit shoulder to shoulder, yet each seems enclosed in his own thoughts. Their pale clothing links them visually, while the different directions of their heads and hands give the photograph a quiet, unsettled rhythm. There is warmth in their closeness, but Enifome allows silence to remain part of the gathering. The picture recognises a familiar human truth: being together does not mean experiencing the same moment. By softening the background into flecks and washes, he gives the men room to be both a group and individuals. It is an understated portrait of companionship, fatigue and the comfort of simply having others nearby.



OE-PH003

Untitled

2016 | 36′ × 36′

Original photography; artistically interpreted digital image

A small assembly of robed figures emerges from a light, textured setting. Their garments overlap, their heads incline towards one another, and the darker central forms hold the loose gathering together.

The surrounding space is reduced to faint suggestions rather than a clearly described location. Enifome leaves the purpose of the gathering open, and that restraint is part of the picture's humanity. We sense familiarity, perhaps a shared errand or a pause in the day, without being told what the people are saying. The delicate disappearance of edges gives the scene the feeling of a memory: recognisable enough to stir curiosity, but too fleeting to be fully recovered.



OE-PH004

Friends

2016 | 36′ × 36′

Original photography; artistically interpreted digital image

Two seated men occupy the foreground. One leans into a long, relaxed posture; the other turns slightly forward, his hands gathered near his knees. Their clothing and headwear share a pale tonal range, against which the darker traces of the background become almost incidental. This is friendship without performance. There is no grand gesture, no demand that the sitters smile or explain themselves. Enifome finds tenderness in proximity and in the ease of two people who appear comfortable with silence. The softened edges lend the encounter a sense of time passing gently, as though the moment matters precisely because nothing extraordinary has to happen.



OE-PH005

The Contrast of Life 1

2018 | 40′ × 36′

Original photography; artistically interpreted digital image

figure wrapped in brilliant red and gold bends forward against a nearly black field. The intensity of the cloth is striking, but the posture is guarded, drawing the body inward rather than outward. Colour commands our attention even as the person's expression remains hidden. Enifome builds the work around that tension. The vivid garment suggests energy and presence; the bowed head speaks a quieter language of vulnerability or private reflection. Neither cancels the other.

The photograph invites us to think about the distance between what a person reveals to the world and what they may be carrying within. It is a portrait of dignity that resists easy interpretation.



OE-PH006

Market Woman

2018 | 30.5′ × 36′

Original photography; artistically interpreted digital image



lone figure stands beside vessels and objects that seem connected with everyday trade. Her silhouette is dark, and much of the surrounding scene has been loosened into ink-like patches. What remains most legible is her upright presence and the small activity gathered around her hands. The work is attentive to labour without making a sentimental emblem of it. Enifome lets the woman hold the image, even as his treatment strips away many of the details by which a passer-by might ordinarily identify her. The result is intimate yet respectful: a moment of work whose repetitive demands are suggested, not narrated, and whose human value lies in the person at its centre.

OE-PH007

The Contrast of Life 2

2018 | 40′ × 36′



An older-looking figure stands in patterned yellow fabric and a white headwrap, surrounded by a street scene rendered largely in grey. The saturated cloth makes the subject immediately visible, while the hands and lowered gaze introduce an unusually quiet centre to a visually busy setting. The selective colour does more than decorate the scene. It makes us notice someone who might otherwise disappear into the movement of the crowd. There is dignity in the careful attention to clothing, but also a suggestion of the weariness of an ordinary day.

Enifome brings these feelings together without forcing a single story onto the sitter. Visibility itself becomes an act of regard.

Fulani Woman

2018 | 24′ × 16′



dark standing figure is set against a restless, pale ground. A broad rounded form rises alongside her, while the figure's clothing and the surrounding marks merge in places. The image gives us a strong bodily presence but very few details that would settle its setting or narrative.

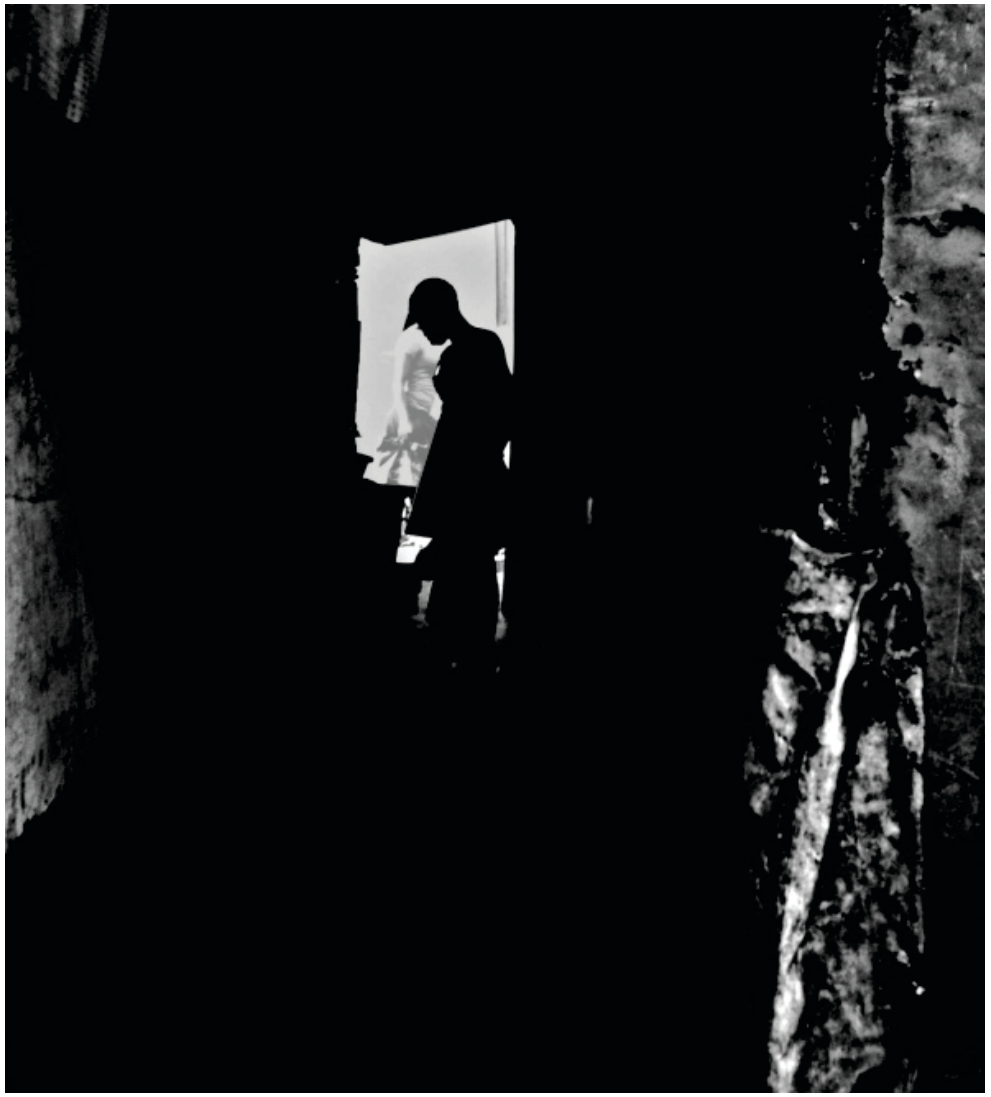
Its mood is one of endurance and reserve. Enifome's dense black shapes give the woman a remarkable solidity, while the dissolved edges suggest the fragility of any passing encounter. The viewer is invited to look carefully rather than claim understanding. Whatever the subject's particular circumstances, the work honours her presence without reducing her to a social category or a picturesque symbol.

OE-PH009

Light at the End of the Tunnel

2018 | 24′ × 21′

Most of the image is consumed by blackness. A narrow opening of white light falls behind the silhouette of a person, who stands at the threshold between what can and cannot be seen. The surrounding walls retain just enough texture to make the darkness feel physical. There is a powerful emotional hesitation here. The title promises hope, yet Enifome does not show us what lies beyond the doorway. The figure could be pausing, arriving or preparing to leave. That uncertainty makes the light meaningful: not a guaranteed rescue, but the possibility of another direction. The image speaks to isolation, courage and the difficult moment before a step is taken.



OE-PH010

Face to Face Conversation

2020 | 15′ × 24



Two small silhouettes sit at opposite ends of a slender boat. Between them, the vessel forms a low dark line over reflective water, while the far bank stretches across a misty horizon. The figures are distant enough that their expressions cannot be read. What holds the photograph is the space between the people. Enifome places conversation within a broad expanse of water and air, allowing the scene to feel both intimate and exposed. Their separation invites us to imagine a shared exchange, but the work wisely withholds its content.

Against the immensity of the landscape, the simple fact of two people being present with one another becomes unexpectedly moving.

OE-PH011

Kids washing By the Banks

2020 | 15′ × 24

band of dark, diminutive figures appears near the water's edge, almost absorbed by the warm gold and brown washes spreading across the picture. The shoreline runs horizontally through a field of light, its detail interrupted by stains, drips and blurred passages. Enifome gives the scene the warmth of a remembered afternoon without erasing its everyday reality. The children are small against the wider environment, yet they animate it completely. There is an easy sense of activity and shared experience, accompanied by a quieter awareness of how quickly such moments pass. The painterly treatment makes recollection itself part of the image: imperfect, luminous and deeply human.



OE-PH012

Argungu Sprint

2026 | 24′ × 32′

Figures move across a pale, dust-filled expanse, their bodies and raised objects cutting dark diagonals through the light. The image seems to catch a rush of collective motion at the point when individual gestures begin to merge into one driving current. Enifome brings excitement into the frame without flattening the participants into spectacle. The hurried silhouettes suggest effort, anticipation and the contagious energy of people moving towards a common purpose. His loose, almost airborne marks make the atmosphere feel charged. Rather than freeze a single heroic action, he lets us experience the vitality and uncertainty of the moment itself.



An edition of one

A SINGLE PHYSICAL PRINT

Each photograph is offered on the basis that only one physical saleable fine art print of the finished image will be produced: a unique edition of 1/1. The edition restriction is intended to apply regardless of future print size or support. Digital working files and non-sale production tests should be documented separately.

WHAT THE BUYER RECEIVES

A completed work should be accompanied by a signed certificate naming the artist, full title, catalogue reference, original capture year (where confirmed), artistic treatment year (where confirmed), final print date, materials, image and sheet dimensions, edition 1/1, and the artist's signature.

PRODUCTION RECORD

Before sale, the selected paper or support, printer and print process should be fixed and recorded. The term "archival pigment print" should only be used where that is the production process actually employed.

AUTHENTICITY AND HISTORY

The artist confirms authorship of the original photographic images and artistic treatments. Ownership is recorded as retained by the artist where applicable; no unverified earlier sale or exhibition history is asserted. Each print should have a matching inventory record and signed certificate.

INTERPRETATION AND FACT

Curatorial writing describes the visual and emotional qualities of an image. It does not claim knowledge of a sitter's identity, personal circumstances or exact words unless independently documented.

Documentation for each work

Each catalogue number identifies one photograph in this selection. Before a physical print leaves the artist's possession, the accompanying signed object record should supply its precise print specifications and edition declaration.

Object record: OE-PH___ | Title | Image capture date | Artistic treatment date | Print date | Printer | Printing process | Paper or other support | Image size | Sheet size | Signature placement | Certificate number | Initial ownership | Condition at transfer.

Dates: The years in the illustrated entries reproduce the years supplied in the source and should not automatically be read as dates of physical printing.

Commercial presentation: Prices are deliberately excluded. A gallery asking price is a commercial proposal, not an independently verified market valuation. It can be added separately once production specifications and sales terms are confirmed.

Editorial integrity: This edition uses the twelve photographs in the latest source document only. No locations, personal histories or biographical claims about the subjects have been invented.

THE ART OF EVERYDAY LIFE

Ozuwo Enifome

Twelve photographic works | 2016–2020

Unique 1/1 physical-print editions

fomeozuwobss@gmail.com